

OMB Control No: 0970-0114

Expiration date: 03/31/2027

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**Appendix 1: Lead Agency Implementation Plan
for**

State/Territory Tennessee

FFY 2025 – 2027

Version: Initial Plan

Plan Status: Approved as of 2024-11-09 00:37:10 GMT

For each non-compliance, Lead Agencies must describe the following:

- **Action Steps:** List the action steps needed to correct the finding (e.g., update policy manual, legislative approval, IT system changes, etc.). For each action step list the:
 - o **Expected Completion Date:** List the expected completion date for the action step.
- **Overall Target Date for Compliance:** List date Lead Agency anticipates completing implementation, achieving full compliance with all aspects of the findings. (Note: Compliance will not be determined until the FFY 2025-2027 CCDF Plan is amended and approved).

EQUAL ACCESS:AFFORDABILITY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide data on the extent to which CCDF providers charge families additional amounts above the required co-payment (including data on the size and frequency of such amounts), as required by 98.45(b)(5). (Plan Question 3.1.2eii)

Overall Target Completion Date: 06/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency will submit an amendment to its State Plan to provide data available on the extent to which CCDF providers charge additional amounts to families above the required co-payment, including size and frequency.	06/30/2024

EQUAL ACCESS:PAYMENT PRACTICES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not pay all provider types prospectively or alternatively does not demonstrate that it is not a generally-accepted practice for all provider types, as required by 98.45(m)(1). (Plan Question 4.4.1a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through April 30, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	Review feedback from providers regarding strategies for paying prospectively.	02/28/2025
2	Provide instructions to vendor for system modifications needed to pay providers prospectively.	04/30/2025

3	Complete policy revisions aligned with paying providers prospectively and complete system modifications.	04/30/2026
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EQUAL ACCESS:PROVIDER OPTIONS FOR PARENTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not provide grants or contracts for direct services for infants and toddlers, for children in underserved geographic areas, and for children with disabilities, as required by 98.30(b)(1). (Plan Questions 4.1.1c and 4.5.1i). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for this requirement through April 30, 2026.

Overall Target Completion Date: 04/30/2026

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency has requested technical assistance from the OCC Regional Office and the National Center on Subsidy Innovation and Accountability.	12/31/2024
2	Gather feedback from providers about strategies to contract for slots in order to grow capacity and support provider sustainability.	04/30/2025
3	Determine procurement strategy, funding structure, and potential system modifications needed to support contracting for slots.	12/31/2025
4	Complete policy revisions, procurement mechanisms, and potential system modifications aligned with contracting for slots.	04/30/2026

EQUAL ACCESS:SUPPLY BUILDING STRATEGIES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not adequately describe strategies to improve the supply and quality of infant/toddler child care, as required by 98.16(y) and (aa). (Plan Question 4.5.4b)

Overall Target Completion Date: 06/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency will submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe strategies that are in place to improve the supply and quality of infant/toddler child care.	06/30/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:ADMINISTRATION OF MEDICATION

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the administration of medication consistent with the standards for parental consent for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(iii). (Plan Questions 5.3.3aiv, 5.3.3av, 5.3.3avi, 5.3.3biv, 5.3.3bv, and 5.3.3bvi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for administration of medication consistent with the standards for parental consent, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child	10/31/2025

	Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and the monitoring tool used to evaluate the administration of medication standard for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:BUILDING AND PHYSICAL PREMISES SAFETY

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for building and physical premises safety, including the identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water, and vehicular traffic for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(v). (Plan Questions 5.3.5aiv, 5.3.5av, 5.3.5avi, 5.3.5biv, 5.3.5bv, 5.3.5bvi, 5.3.5civ, 5.3.5cv, and 5.3.5cvi)
- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on building and physical premises safety, including identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water and vehicular traffic for licensed centers, licensed family child care providers, license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(i). (Plan Question 5.4.1e)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for building and physical premises safety, including identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water, and vehicular traffic and with related pre-service or orientation training requirements, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). Additionally, the Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers for compliance with pre-service or orientation training related to building and physical premises safety, including the identification of and protection from hazards, bodies of water, and vehicular traffic, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, 5.5.2ai, and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may also update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections	10/31/2025
4	Regarding licensed agencies, the Lead Agency has drafted licensing rules revisions to address this issue and will complete the rules promulgation process, and if necessary, may update the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate contract to include this topic among preservice and orientation training requirements.	10/31/2025
5	Regarding license-exempt agencies, the Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for building and physical premises safety for each provider type.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:EMERGENCY PREPAREDNESS AND RESPONSE PLANNING

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers, or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for emergency preparedness and response planning, as required by

98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, 5.5.2ai, and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for emergency preparedness and response planning for each provider type.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:HANDLING AND STORAGE OF HAZARDOUS MATERIALS AND DISPOSAL OF BIOCONTAMINANTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the handling and storage of hazardous materials, including appropriate disposal of biocontaminants for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(viii). (Plan Questions 5.3.8aiv, 5.3.8av, 5.3.8avi, 5.3.8biv, 5.3.8bv, and 5.3.8bvi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers

and license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for handling and storage of hazardous materials and disposal of biocontaminants, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for handling and storage of hazardous materials and disposal of biocontaminants for license-exempt providers	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY: IDENTIFICATION AND REPORTING OF CHILD ABUSE

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the identification and reporting of child abuse and neglect for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(xi). (Plan Questions 5.3.11aiv, 5.3.11av, 5.3.11avi, 5.3.11biv, 5.3.11bv, and 5.3.11bvi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or

license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for identification and reporting of child abuse, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for identification and reporting of child abuse for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PEDIATRIC FIRST AID AND PEDIATRIC CPR

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for pediatric first aid or pediatric cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) for all staff for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(x). (Plan Questions 5.3.10aiv, 5.3.10av, 5.3.10avi, 5.3.10biv, 5.3.10bv, and 5.3.10bvi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed

centers or licensed family child care providers or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for pediatric first aid and pediatric CPR, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, 5.5.2ai, and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation will be reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may also update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for pediatric first aid and CPR for each provider type.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:POSTING INSPECTION REPORTS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not post full monitoring and inspection reports that include all areas of compliance and non-compliance for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, license-exempt in-home providers, and out-of-school programs, as required by 98.33(a)(4). (Plan Question 5.5.4a). Please note the Lead Agency has an approved waiver for portions of this requirement through April 30, 2026.
- The Lead Agency does not post pre-licensing inspection reports for licensed centers

and licensed family child care providers, as required by 98.33(a)(4). (Plan Question 5.5.4a)

- The Lead Agency monitoring and inspection reports do not contain all the required elements, as required by 98.33(a)(4). (Plan Question 5.5.4b)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency's posting of full monitoring reports is being reviewed by the National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCEQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency will identify policy revisions and potential system modifications needed to post pre-licensing inspection reports for licensed child care providers and full monitoring inspection reports that include all areas of compliance and non-compliance for license-exempt providers.	04/30/2025
3	The Lead Agency will provide instructions to its vendor for system modifications needed to post pre-licensing inspection reports for licensed child care providers and full monitoring inspection reports that include all areas of compliance and non-compliance for license-exempt providers.	05/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency will complete policy revisions and system modifications aligned with posting pre-licensing inspection reports and full monitoring inspection reports for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PRECAUTIONS IN TRANSPORTING CHILDREN

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for precautions in transporting children for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(ix). (Plan Questions 5.3.9iv, 5.3.9v, and 5.3.9vi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or

license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for precautions in transporting children, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for precautions in transporting children for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION AND CONTROL OF INFECTIOUS DISEASES

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the prevention and control of infectious diseases (including immunizations) for all licensed-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(i). (Plan Questions 5.3.1aiv, 5.3.1av, 5.3.1avi, 5.3.1biv, 5.3.1bv, and 5.3.1bvi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or

license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for prevention and control of infectious diseases (including immunizations), as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standards and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for the prevention and control of infectious diseases including immunizations for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION AND RESPONSE TO EMERGENCIES FROM FOOD AND ALLERGIC REACTIONS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the prevention of or response to emergencies due to food and allergic reactions for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(iv). (Plan Questions 5.3.4aiv, 5.3.4av, 5.3.4avi, 5.3.4biv, 5.3.4bv, and

5.3.4bvi)

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for prevention of or response to emergencies due to food and allergic reactions, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for the prevention of or response to emergencies due to food and allergic reactions for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:PREVENTION OF SHAKEN BABY SYNDROME, ABUSIVE HEAD TRAUMA, AND CHILD MALTREATMENT

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the prevention of shaken baby syndrome and abusive head trauma for licensed centers and licensed family child care

homes and has not established a standard for the prevention of shaken baby syndrome, abusive head trauma, and child maltreatment for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care homes, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(vi). (Plan Questions 5.3.6ai, 5.3.6aii, 5.3.6aiv, 5.3.6av, 5.3.6avi, 5.3.6biv, 5.3.6bv, and 5.3.6bvi)

- The Lead Agency does not require pre-service or orientation training on prevention of shaken baby syndrome, abusive head trauma, and child maltreatment for licensed centers, licensed family child care providers, license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.44(b)(1)(i). (Plan Question 5.4.1f)

- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or licensed family child care providers, or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers and license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for prevention of shaken baby syndrome, abusive head trauma, and child maltreatment and with related pre-service or orientation training requirements, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii, 5.5.1bii, 5.5.2ai, and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	Regarding licensed agencies, the Lead Agency has drafted licensing rules revisions to address this issue. The Lead Agency had previously begun the rules promulgation process but withdrew the revisions due to unrelated issues.	10/31/2025

	The Lead Agency has restarted and will complete the rules promulgation process.	
5	Regarding license-exempt agencies, the Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standard and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for the prevention of shaken baby syndrome, abusive head trauma, and child maltreatment for each provider type.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY: RATIOS AND GROUP SIZE FOR CCDF PROVIDERS

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a group size for school-age children in licensed centers or license-exempt centers, as required by 98.41(d)(1). (Plan Questions 5.2.2aiv and 5.2.2biv)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual unannounced inspection for licensed centers or an annual inspection for license-exempt centers for compliance with a standard for group size, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(i)(B) and 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.1aii and 5.5.2ai)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may establish group sizes for the 5 and above age groups or submit an amendment to its State Plan detailing requirements that assure the health, safety, and well-being of school-age children without proscribed group size limitations. The Lead Agency will also describe in an amendment to its State Plan the standards and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for ratio and group sizes.	10/31/2025

HEALTH AND SAFETY:SUDDEN INFANT DEATH SYNDROME AND SAFE SLEEP

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency has not established a standard for the prevention of sudden infant death syndrome and use of safe sleep practices for license-exempt centers, license-exempt family child care providers, or license-exempt in-home providers, as required by 98.41(a)(1)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.3.2iv, 5.3.2v, and 5.3.2vi)
- The Lead Agency does not require an annual inspection for license-exempt centers or license-exempt family child care providers for compliance with a standard for prevention of sudden infant death syndrome and use of safe sleep practices, as required by 98.42(b)(2)(ii). (Plan Questions 5.5.2ai and 5.5.2bi)

Overall Target Completion Date: 10/31/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency standard and supporting documentation is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office and National Center on Early Childhood Quality Assurance (NCECQA). The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency may update its contract for all child care providers that participate in the Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed.	10/31/2025
3	The Lead Agency may complete policy revisions, update monitoring tools, and deliver refresher training for staff to ensure all CCDF standards and requirements are addressed during monitoring inspections.	10/31/2025
4	The Lead Agency may submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the standards and monitoring tool used to evaluate the standard for the prevention of sudden infant death syndrome and use of safe sleep practices for license-exempt providers.	10/31/2025

**COMPREHENSIVE BACKGROUND CHECK:PRE-SERVICE CHECK REQUIREMENTS
(PROVISIONAL HIRE)**

Reason(s) for non-compliance:

- The Lead Agency does not require a qualifying result from an FBI criminal background check or in-state criminal background check with fingerprints before a prospective staff member begins work, as required by 98.43(d)(4). (Plan Questions 5.7.12a and 5.7.12b)
- The Lead Agency allows the prospective staff member to work unsupervised before receiving a qualifying result on the comprehensive background check requirements, as required by 98.43(d)(4). (Plan Question 5.7.12i)

Overall Target Completion Date: 06/30/2025

Action Step Number	Action Step Description	Target Completion Date
1	The Lead Agency documentation of requirements for employees to have FBI and in-state criminal background checks prior to having access to children is being reviewed by the OCC Regional Office. The Lead Agency is awaiting the outcome of this review.	02/28/2025
2	The Lead Agency will submit an amendment to its State Plan to describe the background check requirements and supporting background check processes of its Child Care Payment Assistance/Certificate Program contract.	06/30/2025